

SC03 IMPROVE CLEANING PRACTICES | O (MAX: 1 PT)

Intent: Provide effective cleaning by establishing adequate cleaning protocols and practices.

Summary: This feature requires the development of cleaning and disinfection plans that include instructions, training and recordkeeping.

Issue: Cleaning is fundamental for keeping a healthy indoor environment. Microorganisms such as house dust mites – ubiquitously present around the world – are directly related with asthma and allergy development.^{20,21} Surfaces may host pathogens released by sick individuals or through contact with another contaminated surface.³ Cleaning practices may cause additional health concerns. For instance, indiscriminate use of cleaning sprays is suspected to be a risk factor for adult asthma.⁹ Similarly, lack of education on the use of gloves during wet cleaning activities may explain the high prevalence of hand dermatitis in the cleaning service industry.^{22,23}

Solutions: A thorough plan for cleaning operations that considers the health of occupants and cleaning staff increases the overall efficiency of the process, while reducing environmental damage.²⁴ The plan should align with advice from public health agencies for disinfection requirements.²⁵ Along with personal protective equipment (PPE), the implementation of engineering controls (e.g., ventilation) and policies is key to reduce exposure to hazards during cleaning practices.²⁶

Part 1 Part 1 (Max: 1 Pt)

For All Spaces except Dwelling Units:

The project develops and implements a cleaning plan that meets the following requirements:

a. Details the following:

1. Extent and frequency of cleaning.
2. Cleaning responsibilities of building occupants (if any) and cleaning staff.
3. Cleaning supplies and where they can be accessed.
4. Process to evaluate and document adherence to the cleaning plan.

b. Identifies the following:

1. Surfaces that require disinfection (e.g., high-touch surfaces).
2. Frequency and/or other thresholds (e.g., number of hours, number users of a space, results from a swab test) for disinfection.
3. Applicable governmental registration and directions of use (e.g., contact time and dilution rates) for disinfectants.
4. Other non-chemical tools used for disinfection, if any.

c. States the following documentation procedures:

1. Record keeping practices for cleaning and disinfection activities.
2. The chain of communications with building occupants.
3. A system to log feedback from occupants and cleaning staff.

d. Specifies the following for cleaning materials and personal protection equipment (PPE):

1. PPE requirements for general cleaning and specialized tasks (e.g., disinfection or dilution or chemicals).
2. Color-coding for reusable and disposable cleaning cloths.
3. Separate cleaning of reusable cleaning materials from other clothing or products.

e. Includes the following precautions for storage of cleaning products:

1. An identifiable, fit-for-purpose storage space in accordance with the manufacturers' directions; bleach stored away from other products.
2. Color-coding and labeling of any bleach-based and ammonia-based products, indicating they are

not to be mixed with one another.

f. Specifies the following for cleaning tools and equipment:

1. HEPA rated filters for vacuum cleaners.
2. If carpet and woven upholstery are present, the cleaning methodology (based on manufacturer's recommendations), favoring hot water extraction if technically feasible.
3. Protocols for cleaning, maintenance and handling of waste accumulated in equipment (e.g., used vacuum cleaner bags).

g. Includes the following operational aspects:

1. Use of cleaning and disinfection products, including dilutions (when needed) and ventilation requirements.
2. On-site availability of current Safety Data Sheets (SDS) of cleaning and disinfection products, in languages spoken by the cleaning staff.
3. Precautions to avoid slip hazards during and after floor cleaning.
4. Safe disposal of waste, including soiled cleaning materials and PPE.

h. Outlines a training program that meets the following:

1. Training covers cross-contamination prevention via hand hygiene, PPE, cleaning cloth replacement, cloth handling techniques and carrying systems to separate clean tools from dirty ones.
2. Training is delivered to all relevant personnel including building management, building operators and contracted cleaning staff, on an annual basis.

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The project retains a cleaning provider organization certified under one of the following standards:

- a. Green Seal® Standard for Commercial and Institutional Cleaning Services, GS-42, operated by Green Seal Inc.
- b. Cleaning Industry Management Standard (CIMS) - GB criteria, operated by ISSA.
- c. Nordic Swan Ecolabelling for Cleaning Services criteria, operated by Nordic Ecolabelling.
- d. British Institute of Cleaning Science (BISc) accredited training.